

Question:

Debra is monitoring a beehive to see how many bees come and go in a day. She sees 30 bees leave the hive in the first 6 hours, and then she sees 1/2 that many bees return in the next 6 hours. She sees two times as many bees as she saw first leave the hive fly from the hive and leave in the next 6 hours. Then every bee that left before that hadn't already returned returns to the hive in the next 6 hours. How many bees did Debra see return to the hive in the last 6 hours of the day?

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>Debra saw 30 bees leave the hive in the first 6 hours. Then she saw 1 / 2 that many, or 15 bees, return in the next 6 hours. Then she saw 2 x 30 = 60 bees fly from the hive and leave. She already had 15 of those, so 60 - 15 = 45 bees left the hive and departed. Then 30 had not yet returned and then 45 of those return, so there were 30 + 45 = 75 that had returned when the day was over. So Debra saw 75 bees return to the hive in the last 6 hours of the day. </think><answer>75 </answer>

